

Understanding slower adopters

The early majority is the large group of people ready to adopt an innovation when it appears to be taking off, and when they witness the advantages enjoyed by early adopters. Positive experiences by early adopters can encourage the early majority to come on board. The late majority consists of the more conservative members of the group who are only prepared to change when they can see a large population already successfully using the innovation. You can best reach them by promoting positive experiences reported by earlier adopters. Finally, any community will include laggards—a few people extremely resistant to change. A lot of effort will be required to convince these people, and you may decide to leave them be if 100 percent adoption is not essential to your innovation.

SELLING YOUR IDEA



FAST TRACK



OFF TRACK

Communicating in terms that your prospective users recognize

Use jargon and specialized language

Understanding their world—seeing the innovation through their eyes

Making assumptions that they can see the benefits the way you do

Listening to their concerns—and if possible build their ideas, wishes, and needs into the final version

Presenting them with a “take it or leave it” solution and ignoring their feedback

Developing a relationship with them: engage them as partners in the development of the innovation

Treating them as passive end-users and expecting them simply to do as they are told